



Advertising is salesmanship mass produced. No one would bother to use advertising if he could talk to all his prospects face-to-face. But he can't.



-Morris Hite



Latest technologies to look out for

Wireless speaker brands are adding a gamut of interesting features for better user satisfaction.

Manoj Kumar Pansari, chief executive officer, Astrum Holdings Ltd, says, "For a mid-range, home-use speaker, look for good sound clarity, sleek and aesthetic design, in-built microphone and dual pairing. If outdoor use is intended, check for good bass and higher root mean square (RMS) power for louder output. More interesting additions may include a digital clock and FM radio. Higher battery life, USB support and water resistance are also important."

Sharan Maini, director - business development, JVC India, talks about some of the advanced technologies. He says, "The build of the speakers is being made sturdier to make these damage-resistant when being carried around. A popular feature is the integration of one-touch keys for controlling the various aspects of sound, like bass and treble. Smart equaliser settings are also available in many speakers for auto-setting sound parameters."

Maini shares another interesting fact, "Integration of voice assistants is another significant trend in the speakers, where users just need to speak out commands to control these. JVC will launch a new Bluetooth speaker in a month's time with Amazon Alexa integrated. It is planned to be priced at ₹ 4999."

If you are purchasing from retail, it is recommended to give the product a test run to verify the sound quality. Keeping all these features in mind, we explore some of the latest and innovative products in the market. We will restrict our choices to a budget of ₹ 15,000.

Astrum ST250 Bluetooth clock speaker. Astrum Holdings offers

ST250 Bluetooth speaker that creates an output audio of 10W. It equalises bass, trebles and mids with a frequency response between 60Hz and 18kHz. This Bluetooth speaker can hold an expanded memory through SD cards or TF flash cards up to 32GB.

The speaker has a touch-based control with a sleek and stylish design. The USP of this indoor speaker is the presence of an integrated digital clock, location temperature display and FM radio. LED backlights enable easy interaction with a nice aesthetic touch. ST250 is priced at ₹ 3999.

Logitech Ultimate Ears WonderBoom. Logitech offers a powerful portable speaker unit in the form of WonderBoom. Its unique round appearance has a 360-degree output setup paired with uniquely-designed large power buttons on the front. The



Front (left) and top (right) views of WonderBoom

10.2-centimetre long speaker with a diameter of 9.4 centimetres comes with an auto-set equaliser balance (bass, treble and mid), supporting a range of 80Hz to 20kHz frequency. The battery, on full charge, can run the speaker for up to 10 hours, and is rechargeable through a microUSB port.

WonderBoom brings with it a number of fascinating features. Its Bluetooth module allows connectivity up to an extended range of 33 metres and can support up to two Bluetooth source devices (smartphones/tablets/computers), simultaneously.

Even more interestingly, two separate speaker units can be played conjointly by pressing a button on top of the speaker till these get connected to each other.